SMU DSA DATA CASE 2026 · LIVES GROUP

Meet Sappy: the Master Data Pet that keeps SAP B1 clean and grows sales

Bad master data is invisible, so nobody owns it. **We gave it a face.** Sappy's health *is* your data's health.

😾 The problem

- **Email-driven MDM:** no standard form, so requests bounce; approvers don't see them; Amy's item code took **18 days**.
- **Duplicates** ("Natl. Univ. Hospital" vs "National University Hospital") cause wrong invoices **and** distort regional PO history.
- **No audit trail**; bank details travel by plain email.
- **IT needed** for every new BU, field or approval step.
- **Forecasts** use flat 6–12-month averages that miss seasonality, churn and cross-sell across A/B/C in 5 countries.

One root cause → two problems: dirty data in = slow operations and wrong commercial decisions.

💡 Our solution: Sappy, inside Microsoft Teams

FEATURE (FUN NAME)	WHAT IT DOES	PAIN POINT FIXED
🍡 **Feed Sappy**	Smart form: fields and approval route change by request type; incomplete requests get spat back	No standard form
💕 **It's a Match!**	Fuzzy duplicate check while typing; "use existing" or justify the override	Duplicates
👉 **Swipe to approve**	Teams adaptive cards, 24 h nudge, 72 h escalation; Sappy gets sad when you wait	2–3 week approvals
📦 **Parcel tracking**	Every request shows where it is and its ETA	"What happened to my request?"
📜 **Sappy's Diary**	Hash-chained audit log; sensitive fields masked, every peek logged	Audit & security
🧩 **Rule Lego**	MDM team adds fields, steps, BUs and domains themselves	IT for every change
🚀 **One-click to SAP B1**	Approved form → SAP B1 Service Layer, with no re-keying	Manual keying
🌱🔮 **Garden + Crystal Ball**	5-country × A/B/C view, seasonal forecast, churn & cross-sell alerts	Weak forecasting
📮 **Inbox Sorter**	Splits POs from enquiries, follow-ups and MDM requests	Mixed inbox

Request → live in SAP B1
18 → ~3 days
parallel-ready routing + nudges

Forecast error (back-test, WAPE)
12.6% → 4.6%
63% less error · wins 13 of 15 series

Team time saved
~60 h / month
≈0.4 FTE: no chasing, no re-keying*

Duplicate rate at creation
~8% → <1%*
blocked before an approver sees them

* Assumptions: ~60 MDM requests/month; 45 min chasing + 15 min re-keying saved per request; 8% current duplicate rate. All prototype data is synthetic.

Clean data makes the forecast smarter, and the forecast finds the sales growth

🌱 5 countries × Products A/B/C · Nov '25 – Oct '26 (customer POs only)

COUNTRY	🌷 A	🌻 B	💐 C	TOTAL UNITS	YOY
Singapore	9,144	4,576	754	14,474	+3.0%
Malaysia	7,659	3,409	881	11,949	+17.8%
Thailand	9,973	3,028	929	13,930	−1.3%
Vietnam	9,733	5,350	664	15,747	**+35.4%**
Indonesia	7,395	3,700	905	12,000	+11.6%
All 5	**43,904**	**20,063**	**4,133**	**68,100**	**+12.7%**

__Growth__ = PO units Aug–Oct '26 ÷ Aug–Oct '25 − 1 (season-fair). __Churn signal__ = 3-month momentum ≤ −30%. MDM setup requests, enquiries and follow-ups are counted separately and excluded.

✅ Recommended actions

- 📈 **Vietnam, Product B** (+38% YoY): raise Nov–Jan allocation **~18%** ahead of the December budget-flush peak.
- 🥀 **Save at-risk accounts:** Bangkok Hospital (Product A falling fast), Mayapada (all lines). Account review within 2 weeks.
- 👻 **NUH looked like churn but wasn't**: 60% of its orders had moved to a duplicate record. **Merge before you call.**
- 🪴 **Cross-sell B** to Medlatec (VN, ~+79 units/mo) and Prodia (ID, ~+58 units/mo); **C** to Cho Ray.
- ❄️ Expect a **~23% February dip** (Lunar New Year / Tết); don't misread it as churn.

🔮 How AI beats "Grandma's Average"

Today: flat 6-month average. Sappy: **clean → learn seasonality pooled across all 15 country×product series → trend → re-season**. Back-tested on Aug–Oct '26: **WAPE 12.6% → 4.6%**. Dec '26 forecast: **7,295 units vs 5,928** flat, so we avoid under-ordering at the peak. Automated monthly, replacing ~2 days of spreadsheet work per cycle*.

🤔 Why this, not the alternatives?

- **vs. tweaking the email process:** no dedupe, no audit trail, still invisible.
- **vs. a custom portal:** needs developers Lives Group doesn't have. Sappy runs on **M365 they already own**.
- **vs. an enterprise MDG suite:** overkill and costly at SAP B1 scale.
- **Not in v1:** auto-create without human check, LLM chatbot, ML dedupe, mobile app.

💸 Business case & adoption

~S$20–25k cash, ~10 weeks: Power Apps/Automate licences (~S$8k) + SAP B1 Service Layer connector partner (~S$12k, 10 days); MDM team + 1 maker build the rest*. Payback well under a year from ~0.4 FTE saved, before any sales uplift. **Getting people to use it:** lives in Teams (no new login) · MDM mailbox auto-replies "Sappy can't eat emails 😍" with a pre-filled link · after month 2, **no form = no SAP record** · pilot SPD first · monthly "Sappy's Favourite Human" shout-out.